HOLE/MOUND

AKTION / INSTALLATION, ROLDISLEBEN / THÜRINGEN, 2023



Hole/Mound (2023) Roldisleben / Thüringen

The Thuringian Basin is one of the oldest cultural landscapes in Germany. Its fertile soils have attracted people for millennia; they have played an important role in the history of settlement and are the basis of the region's agriculture. At the same time, Thuringia today faces new challenges: rural exodus, declining trust in democracy and radical political tendencies increasingly threaten the social fabric. Against this background, in 2023 YRD.Works developed the participatory art action and temporary intervention Hole/Mound on a barley field in Roldisleben, Thuringia.

At the centre of the work were two six-metre-high timber pavilions built by YRD.Works, which, positioned on a hill above the village, were visible from afar. An industrial conveyor belt connected the two identical pavilions, standing five metres apart. They seemed to mirror each other but differed in their contrasting colour and above all in their function: the black pavilion served as a dig site, while the white pavilion served as an exhibition space.

Visitors could become part of Hole/Mound and actively contribute to the action, which was planned to last three months. With spades, shovels and pickaxes, they dug an ever-deepening hole in the middle of the black pavilion and shovelled the excavated soil onto the mechanical conveyor belt. This carried the earth into the white pavilion, where it fell into the centre of the room and, over the three months, formed a steadily growing mound.

While the hole in the black pavilion grew deeper with every shovelful, the mound in the white pavilion rose continuously. Through this reciprocal dynamic, Hole/Mound produced two opposing yet mutually dependent forms that, among other things, visualised the collective action of all visitors over the course of a summer.





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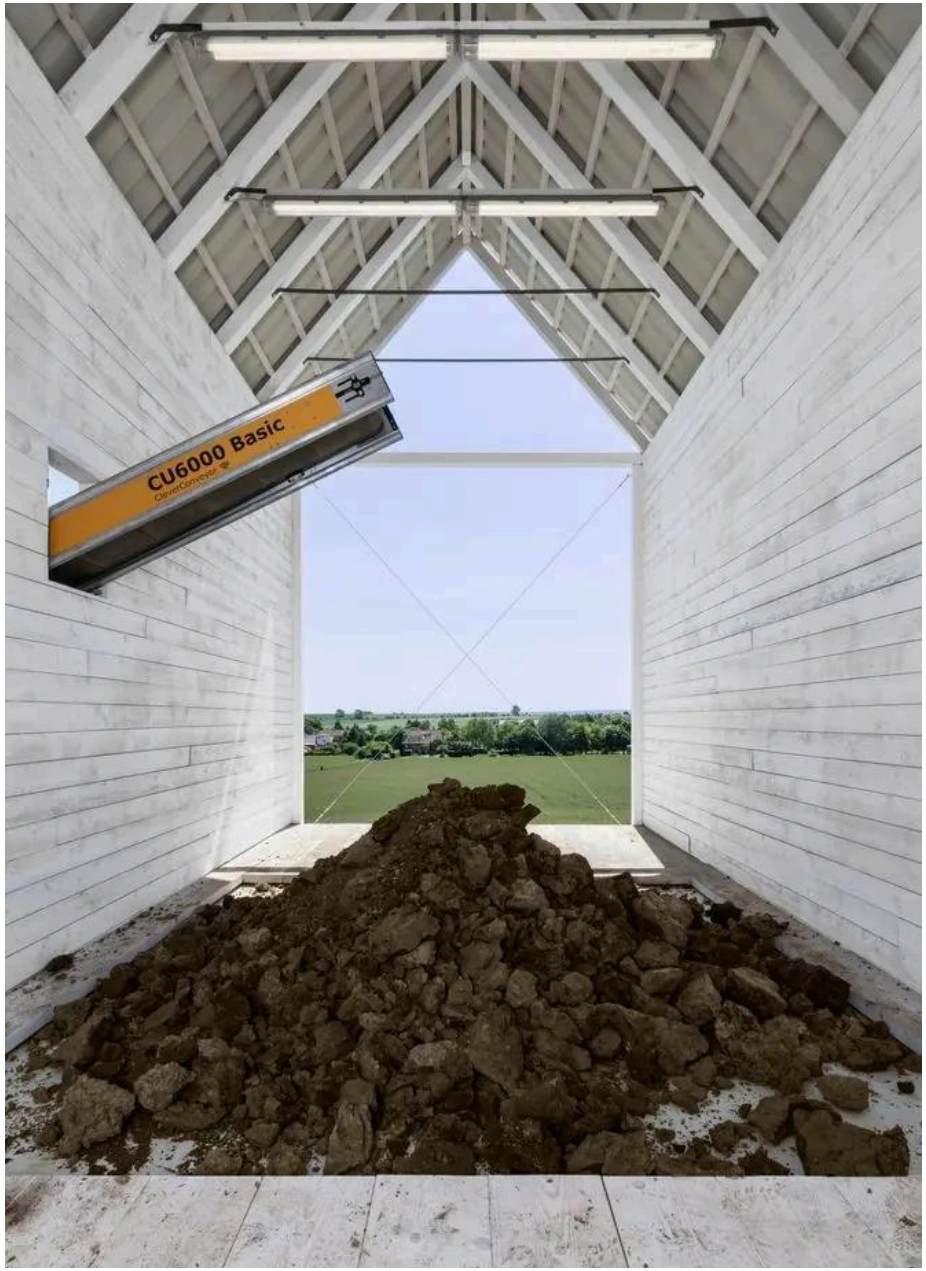


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